A New Old World
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REVIEW

- The flood account is essentially about God
  - God is the only one who speaks
  - Human actions are only in response to God

- The flood account is about God's response to humanity's ruin of creation
  - God cleanses creation
  - God judges humanity, but also provides deliverance

- But humanity hasn't changed
- God promises never to again de-create the world
- That presents a dilemma . . .
- So God changes some things while keeping other things the same.

(Continuous uninterrupted speeches by the same person with distinct speech orienters is a common ancient literary device used to indicate sections.)

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GEN 8:21-22

And the Lord said in his heart,
I will not again curse the ground on account of man,
for the thought of man's heart is evil from his youth;
And I will not again destroy every living thing, as I have done.
Henceforth, all the days of the earth,
seed time and harvest,
and cold and heat,
and summer and winter,
and day and night,
will not cease.

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God's First Speech

- A clear allusion to the creation account, specifically Day 6

	Day 6	Post-Flood Re-creation
Speech Type	self-speech by God	self-speech by God

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Speech Type	self-speech by God	self-speech by God
Subject	humanity in the earth	humanity in the earth
Relationship to the Earth	rule	------

- No longer a statement regarding humanity's purpose
- Given the obvious parallels, this omission is significant
  - Humanity's role to rule animals is no longer an issue

(Just as his subduing the earth ceased outside of Eden)

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GEN 9:1-7

And God blessed Noah and his sons, and said to them,
Be fruitful and multiply and fill the earth.
And let the fear of you and the dread of you be upon every animal of the earth,
and upon all birds of the heavens
upon all that moves on the ground
and upon all the fish of the sea:
Into your hand they are delivered.
Every moving thing that lives will be food for you.
As the grain I give you everything.
Only, the flesh with its life, its blood, you shall not eat.
And indeed, your blood, the blood of your lives, will I require:
At the hand of every animal will I require it.
At the hand of man, at the hand of each the blood of his brother, I will require the life of man.
Whoever sheds man's blood, by man shall his blood be shed;
for in the image of God he made man.
But you all, be fruitful and multiply: swarm on the earth, and multiply on it

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God's Second Speech

- ***<u>Another</u>*** clear allusion to the creation account, specifically, Day 6

	Day 6	Post-Flood Re-creation
Speech Type	blessing	blessing

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Speech Type	blessing	blessing
Subject	humanity in the earth	humanity in the earth
Relationship to Animals	rule	fear and dread animals for food
Relationship to the Earth	subdue	-------

- Humanity's relationship to animals changes dramatically
- Humanity's relationship to the earth changes (officially)
- ***Again***, given the parallels, the changes are significant

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POST-FLOOD CHANGES

- The focus of the post-flood speeches is on humanity
  - The creation account focused on God's life-giving work using humanity
  - Post-flood focuses on changes due to humanity's failure

- What is now God's focus?

The restoration of humanity

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POST-FLOOD CHANGES

- God cleans creation
- Problem:
  - Humanity is still sinful
  - Humanity is still his image *(his representative in creation)*
  - Therefore, humanity will again ruin creation

    (do the same thing the same ways . . .)
- Resolution
  - Something must change . . .

    salvation in the midst of judgment

  - Based on the analysis of God's speeches . . .

    creational responsibilities are replaced by the need for deliverance

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Humans and Animals

- Creation:
  - humans and animals introduced in terms of created life
- Eden-Cain Stories:
  - both humans and animals created as living creatures

    but not a suitable helper
  - animals die to cover human sin and shame
  - humans given the same food as animals
  - remembering animal death to cover human sin shown in Abel's gift
- Flood
  - animals and humans together referred to as corrupted "all flesh"
  - animals and humans together referred to as "all flesh" needing salvation
  - animals and humans together given a promise of no more de-creation
- Post-Flood
  - abrupt change in animal-human relationship

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Humans and Animals

Biblical Pattern

- Nature
  - similar nature: both “living creatures”
  - but different:
    - humans created in the likeness of God
    - humans given the “breath of God”
    - animals almost, but not quite, suitable as human helpers
- Biblical Presentation
  - humans and animals are lumped together an abundance of times
  - humans apart from a proper relationship with God are simply animals

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- *Why are we regarded as beasts and considered stupid in your sight?* *(Job 18:3)*
- *God . . . who teaches us more than beasts* *(Job 35:11)*
- *A man . . . [that] doesn't understand and is the like beasts that perish* *(Ps 49:12)*
- *Man . . . [that] doesn't understand is like the beasts that perish* *(Ps 49:20)*
- *Then I was ignorant . . . I was as a beast before you* *(Ps 73:22)*

Daniel:

- Nations presented as a person (statue) in Daniel 2
- Same nations presented as beasts in Daniel 7
- In between, Nebuchadnezzar goes from human to animal

  Is this not great Babylon that I have built?
- and back to human

  The Most High rules over the kingdom of men . . .

Revelation:

- Evil powers presented as animals
  - Satan > a dragon
  - False Prophet > a beast
  - Antichrist > a beast

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Humans and Animals

Post-Flood Relationship

- Humans and animals are now alienated
- Humans are given animals as food
  - What does it mean for humans now to eat animals?
  - Development of the symbolism
    - animals die to cover human sin and shame
    - animals die in remembrance of God's covering human sin and shame
    - death of animals as a substitute now to be made part of self *(eat)*
- The new focus: humans need salvation, but thru death of a substitute

Interesting Fact:

- A common judgment motif in Scripture is animals eating human flesh

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SANCTITY OF HUMAN LIFE

Be fruitful, multiply and fill the earth.
And the fear and dread of you will be on all the living creatures of the earth
and upon all the birds of the heavens.
I have given you power over all that moves upon the ground
and all the fish of the sea.
All that move and have life in it will be food for you.
Just like the green herbs, I have given you all.
But be sure not to eat the flesh with its life, that is, its blood.
But your lifeblood I will require.
From every beast will I require it, and from man.
From his fellow man I will require the life of man.

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NET TRANSLATION

Be fruitful, multiply and fill the earth.
And the fear and dread of you will be on all the living creatures of the earth
and upon all the birds of the heavens.
I have given you power over all that moves upon the ground
and all the fish of the sea.
All that move and have life in it will be food for you.
Just like the green herbs, I have given you all.
But be sure not to eat the flesh with its life, that is, its blood.
And your lifeblood I will ~~require~~ exact punishment.
From every beast will I ~~require it~~ exact punishment, and from man.
From his fellow man I will ~~require~~ exact punishment for the life of man,
since the man was his relative.

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ESV TRANSLATION

Be fruitful, multiply and fill the earth.
And the fear and dread of you will be on all the living creatures of the earth
and upon all the birds of the heavens.
I have given you power over all that moves upon the ground
and all the fish of the sea.
All that move and have life in it will be food for you.
Just like the green herbs, I have given you all.
But be sure not to eat the flesh with its life, that is, its blood.
And your lifeblood I will require a reckoning.
From every beast will I require it, and from man.
From his fellow man I will require a reckoning for the life of man.

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QUESTIONS

- What does it mean to not “eat blood”?
- What is the significance of eating flesh but not the blood?
- What does it mean to “require life”?
- Does this text talk about vengeance? If so, how does that fit the story?
- Does this text talk about capital punishment? If so, how does it fit the story?
- Is this statement presenting a prediction or divine imposition?

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Eating Blood

- Common Understanding:
  - “You can eat animals, but do not eat/drink their blood.”
  - That doesn’t reflect the Hebrew or most English translations.
- Hebrew:
  - “Surely flesh with its life, its blood, you will not eat.”

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EATING BLOOD

- Common Understanding:
  - "You can eat animals, but do not eat/drink their blood."
  - That doesn't reflect the Hebrew or most English translations.
- Hebrew:
  - "Surely ***flesh with its life***, its blood, ***you will not eat***."
- Therefore . . .
  - It is not "don't eat blood"
  - It is "don't eat flesh with its life"
    - "blood" is simply an explanation of "life" *(see Lev 17:11)*
- Conclusion:
  - The command is to not eat an animal while it is still alive.

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Sanctity of Human Life

Be sure not to eat the flesh with its life, that is, its blood.
But your lifeblood I will require.
From every beast will I require it, and from man.

- The Hebrew indicates that …
  - the second line is contrastive,

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  - and "your flesh, your life" is emphasized *(word order)*

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SANCTITY OF HUMAN LIFE

Be sure not to eat the flesh with its life, that is, its blood.
But ***your lifeblood*** *I will require.*
From every beast will I require it, and from man.

- The Hebrew indicates that …
  - the second line is contrastive,
  - and "your flesh, your life" is emphasized *(word order)*
  - thus, emphasizing the importance of human life
- Literal translation . . .

Surely, the flesh with its life, its blood, you will not eat.
But*, surely,* ***your blood, your life****, I will require.*

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Vengeance?

And your lifeblood I will require.
From every beast will I require it, and from man.

- Conflicting ideas presented in English translations:
  - "I will avenge your life"
  - "I will take vengeance upon you"
- Literal Hebrew translation:

  And surely, your blood to your life I will pursue.
  From the hand of all living creatures will I pursue it,
  and from the hand of man.

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  *and **from the hand** of man.*

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"PURSUE BLOOD"

- Hebrew > *darash*
  - Wide range of applications of "pursue"
- Pursue Blood? *(darash damym)*
  - Carries a consistent meaning, especially when used with "from the hand of"
    - The one who has the hand is the one held accountable, not the one holding someone accountable
  - Therefore, the object of pursuit is not what is being chased, but something that is esteemed valuable.
  - Therefore, *God says*
    - ***that he holds human life valuable,*** *and . . .*
    - ***he holds both animals and humans accountable for human life***

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Additional Line

But surely, your lifeblood I will pursue.
From the hand of all living creatures will I pursue it,
and from the hand of man.
From the hand of man his brother I will pursue the life of man.

- ***NOW***, God states that he is pursuing life, not blood (the killing of life)
- "Pursuing life"?
  - Common understanding > people trying to kill others
  - But, that phrase, ***with darash***, appears only one other time *(Ps 142:4)*
  - The meaning is the opposite – It's about ***protecting*** someone's life
  - God is requiring humans to care for the lives of others
  - We ***ARE*** our brother's keeper!

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Capital Punishment?

He who sheds blood, by man his blood will be shed.

- Question:
  - A statement of what will happen . . .
  - or the institution of capital punishment?

- Suggested Answer: A statement of what will happen
- Rationale:
  - Nothing in the context contains or hints at human government
  - Context is sanctity of human life and consequence for killing
  - Those who kill others will be killed by others
    "Those that live by the sword will die by the sword" Jesus *(Matt 26:52)*

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GOD'S SECOND SPEECH

(a paraphrase)

Be fruitful, multiply and fill the earth.
But the fear and dread of you will be on all the living creatures of the earth
and upon all the birds of the heavens.
I have given you power over all that moves upon the ground and all the fish of the sea
All that move and have life in it will be food for you.
Just like the green herbs, I have given you everything.
But be sure not to eat the flesh with its life, that is, its blood.
But ***your*** *blood,* ***your*** *life, I will certainly watch over.*
I will hold both animals and man responsible for your blood.
I will also hold each man responsible for the welfare of his brother.
The basis for this accountability is that God made man in his image.
Now **you***, you be fruitful, multiply. Spread over the earth and multiply in it.*

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God's Second Speech

Summary

- God reestablishes creation, but with changes
  - Humans no longer to subdue the earth or rule animals
  - There is estrangement between humans and animals
  - The focus is now on human
    - animals as food > focus on need for salvation
    - no killing humans > human life is sacred
  - The focus is now on human salvation
- God has not rejected his representative, but his representative must be restored.

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Corruption . . . Again!

- Noah's drunkenness *(recalling Eden)*
  - a human working the cursed ground
  - sin connected to nakedness
- Sin of Ham *(recalling Cain)*
  - how people treat others
  - sin affecting future generations
- Table of Nations
  - all sorts of divisions among humanity (lands, languages, nations, families)
  - another city *(Cain)*, which turns into a kingdom *(human rather than divine rule)*
  - a human king *(sons of God)*
- Tower of Babel
  - Jumps back into the Table of Nations
  - Explains the pride and arrogance leading to divisions of humanity
- Storyline now transitions to the working out of God's salvation *(Abraham)*

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GENESIS 1-11

- God's work is converting death to life
- God chooses to use humanity in his work
- Humanity failed and ruined creation
- God starts again, but now focused on human salvation
- Human salvation
  - recognized weakness
  - trusting God to provide the salvation
- Humanity must . . .
  - obey & trust God
  - wait for his salvation

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